

stance and conditions them for the best way to appreciate the movie, which is simply to submit and go along for the ride.

Pulp Fiction, in all its obscene glory, is perhaps one of the best examples in movies of how originality and daring will win out. There were a lot of obstacles between the critical establishment and the movie, from its language to its violence to its subject matter (indeed, it was famously and controversially beaten to the 1995 Best Picture Oscar by Steven Spielberg's far more conventional *Forrest Gump*), yet its enduring popularity shows that it functions perfectly as a showcase for Tarantino's talent as a filmmaker, with the broken structure allowing for singular moments of directorial flair to become prominent instead of being lost as part of the whole. If

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You get intoxicated by it... high on the rediscovery of how pleasurable a movie can be. I'm not sure I've ever encountered a filmmaker who combined discipline and control with sheer wild-ass joy the way that Tarantino does.

Owen Gleiberman
Entertainment Weekly, 1994

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you're looking for a fresh and engrossing take on the well-trodden territory of the criminal underworld, you can't do much better than *Pulp Fiction*. ■



Quentin Tarantino
Director

Quentin Tarantino was born in Knoxville, Tennessee, in 1963. After dropping out of high school at 15 to pursue an acting career, he was diverted into writing scripts by a meeting with producer Lawrence Bender. His first movie, *Reservoir Dogs*, gained him international acclaim, and his follow-up, *Pulp Fiction*, won the Palme d'Or as well as earning him the Oscar for Best Original Screenplay. Tarantino has since made movies in a variety of genres, from revenge thrillers in the *Kill Bill* series to war movies with *Inglourious Basterds* (2009) and Westerns with *Django Unchained*. His movies continue to do well with both critics and audiences.

Key movies

1992 *Reservoir Dogs*

1994 *Pulp Fiction*

2003 *Kill Bill: Volume 1*

2012 *Django Unchained*

Although he is being held at gunpoint, Pumpkin (Tim Roth) is about to witness a truly unusual moment of enlightenment as Jules vows to change his ways.

